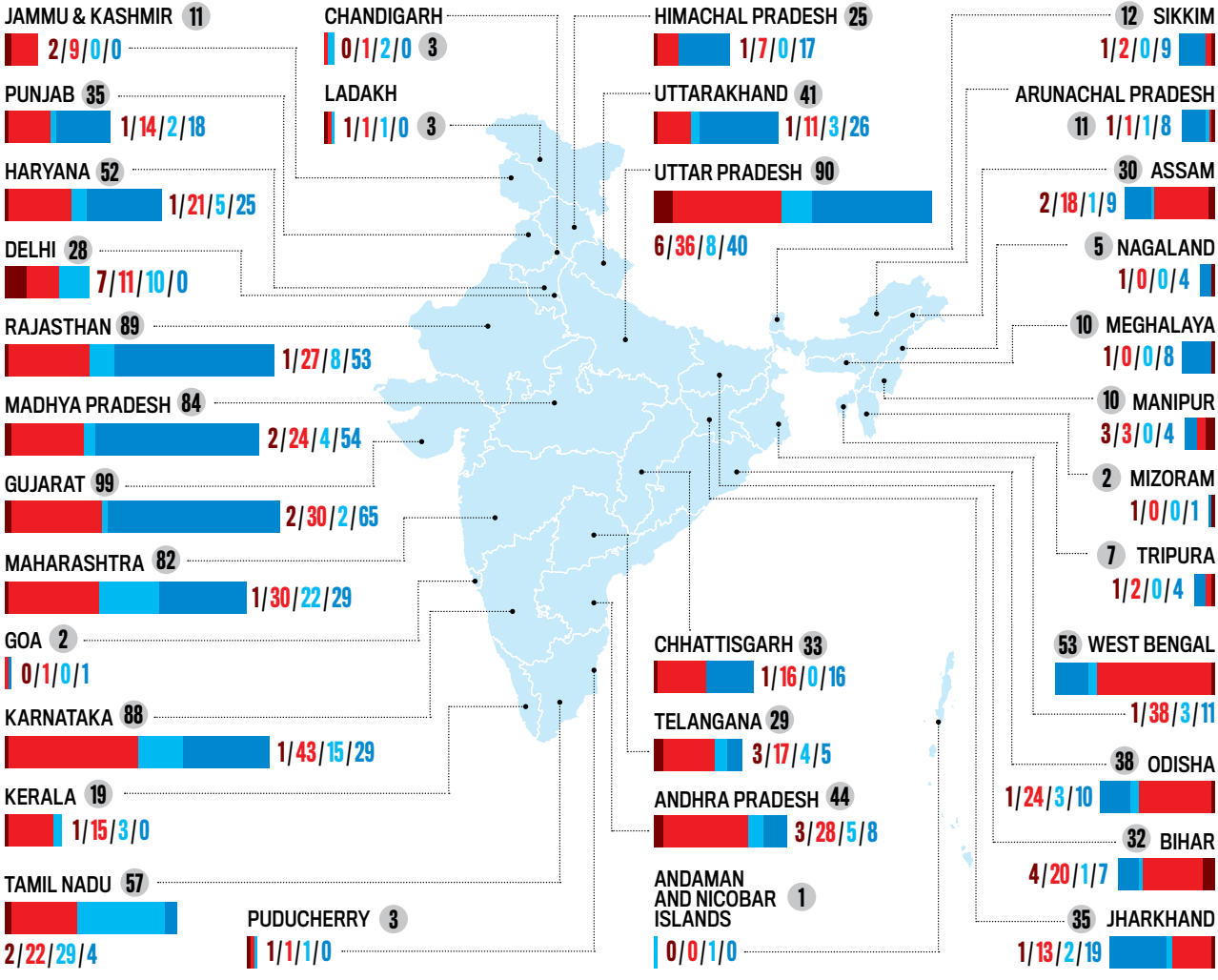
# SPREAD OF THE UNIVERSITIES




*Graphic by*
TANMOY CHAKRABORTY

search output increased by 54 per cent, making it the fourth-largest globally. Indian institutions excelled in fields such as Computer Science, Chemistry, Biological Sciences, Business Studies and Physics.

Despite these positive developments, disparities in access and quality of education have remained a major challenge for Indian universities. Regulatory bodies like the University Grants Commission (UGC) and the All India Council for Technical Education (AICTE) oversee quality standards, but maintaining these standards across a vast number of institutions is a constant work in progress. This makes regular monitoring crucial to ensure equity in the distribution of quality education.

This is something the India Today Group's annual rankings of India's best universities have been doing for the past decade. Not only do they foster a competitive spirit among universities, they also provide students and parents with valuable information to help them make informed choices.

Conducted by India's leading research agency, the Marketing and Development Research Associates (MDRA), the survey has become an essential tool to measure the academic and infrastructural status of Indian universities. Its growing acceptance and credibility are evident from the increase in the number of participating universities, from 120 in 2019 to 173 this year.

Like every year, the 2024 rankings too help us map the educational